

KBS MISSION

We educate students and generate business knowledge to lead and contribute to a globalized world in a responsible and practical manner.

KBS Values

Globalization, Practicality, Leadership, Integrity

GLOBAL BUSINESS ENVIRONMENT AND ETHICS

Graduate School of Business

Konkuk University

Fall 2025

Instructor:	Dr. Kwangsoo Kim	Phone:	450-4146
Office:	Room 514, Business Building	E-mail:	kkim@konkuk.ac.kr
Office Hours:	After class or by appointment	Class Hours:	Tuesday: 19:00-22:00pm
Website	http://ecampus.konkuk.ac.kr	Classroom:	305

COURSE DESCRIPTION

Global Business Environment and Ethics is a foundation course for Global Strategy and Strategic Management in our MBA program, and in this course you will primarily study and experience the global environmental challenges, including ethical issues, facing many different companies. With enhanced globalization in recent years, firms increasingly find that their business is global in nature. To be successful in this global world, it is crucial for firms to have a clear understanding of global business environment and ethics and their implications for management in a global marketplace. Global business environment and ethics provides the global context in which firms operate globally, and they are composed of such factors as cross-border trade and investment, foreign exchange markets, regionalization and globalization, political/legal and economic differences across countries, cultural differences across countries, ethical issues, and cross-border markets for end-products, raw materials, components, technology, labor, and capital. Hence, the central questions to consider are: 1) *what are some key factors of global business environment and ethics?* 2) *what implications do they have for managing companies in a global marketplace?*

LEARNING GOALS

By the end of this course, you should be able to:

1. *Apply your understanding of global business environment and ethics and their implications for business to addressing complex management and ethical issues with a global perspective.*
2. *Demonstrate an ability to solve complex, practical business problems through various analytical methods for effective and efficient decision-makings.*
3. *Demonstrate an ability to communicate ideas and solutions effectively, both orally and in writing.*
4. *Have an ability to collaborate with team members for effective leadership in collective problem-solving settings*
5. *Demonstrate an ability to recognize ethical issues and make decisions in a socially responsible manner.*

Please remember that learning is a three-way game.

What you get out of the course depends as much on you and your colleagues as it does on me.

METHODOLOGY

Procedures to accomplish these goals include: readings, mini-lectures, class discussions, videos, case studies, and written and oral reports. Students must come to class well prepared for discussions on cases and others.

COURSE MATERIALS

Required Course Packet: Articles, book chapters, and cases are assembled in a course packet, which is available at the copy center on the first floor of the Sang Huh Research Building.

ASSESSMENT

Coursework:	<u>100%</u>
Participation	30%
Individual Topic Presentation	15%
Individual Case Project	20%
Team Field Project	35%
Peer Evaluation	To be used to convert team scores into individual scores

Code of Conduct: All work undertaken and submitted in this course is governed by the Students' Code of Conduct. The students who violate these rules on academic dishonesty are subject to a disciplinary penalty, including the possibility of failure in this course or dismissal from school.

Participation (30%)

Pedagogically, this course will rely very heavily on experiential learning built around discussion on cases and other articles during class sessions. For the course to be useful to you, it is essential that, besides reading the conceptual articles, *you come to class well prepared to discuss your analysis of the assigned case and other reading materials. When you do not have enough time to read everything, please read the assigned case first.*

I would strongly encourage active participation. My experience has been that students generally tend to underestimate the worth of what they have to say. Thus, if you are ever in doubt, I would encourage you to participate rather than to keep quiet. Please note that probing questions are as useful a form of participation as presentations of logical analyses. Finally, needless to add, the quantity of your participation would count positively only if the substantive quality of your comments and/or questions adds value to our discussion.

I reserve the right to cold call on individuals. Part of my role as the facilitator for discussion is to help all of us progress in our thinking. I am open to experimentation with new ideas, and you should be patient of your classmates. A good discussion often transpires among the students (i.e., students responding to, questioning, or building upon the comments of classmates), not simply a series of dialogues between individual students and the professor. In order to do this effectively, you must be a good listener as well as communicator.

Attendance is mandatory. You are required to attend all the scheduled class sessions, and you will be penalized for absence. If you must miss class, please contact me before class. It is our university policy that you must attend over and above two-thirds of class sessions to pass a course.

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Individual Topic Presentation (15%)

You individually are required to do an oral presentation on a chosen topic related with Sessions 2 through 5 in our course schedule. The topic can be anything related with global trade, global investment, global financial environments, and regional economic blocks. There is no fixed format for this project, but *it is mandatory to discuss the implications of your chosen topic (related with the global business environment) for companies or governments. You are required to discuss the effects of the global business environment related to your chosen topic on companies or governments. Or you may discuss how a company or government has reacted to the change in the global business environment that your topic deals with.* You will make an oral presentation for 15-20 minutes, followed by a Q&A session for 5-10 minutes. This project does not require a written report, and it only requires an oral presentation with PPT material. This project will be evaluated based on the content and style of your presentation.

Individual Case Project (20%)

You individually are required to make an oral presentation based on a case selected from 6 different cases listed in the course schedule. Case assignment will be made in class. Presentations should be about 30-40 minutes in length followed by a 15-20 minute Q&A session. Presentations should be professional, using power point slides. There is no fixed format for the presentations, but you may want to cover the following in your presentation: 1) review and analyze the case to make sure that everyone knows about the case; 2) deal with the decision issue(s) presented in the case by presenting your recommendations; 3) present the more recent development of the company and/or industry in the case after the case was written; 4) present your conclusions and implication with your insight and lessons learned or takeaways. The depth of your analysis, the ability to defend your recommendations, and the quality of your conclusions and implications will be important factors of evaluation.

Team Field Project (35%)

This project requires each team to perform country and industry/market profiling preparing for foreign market entry of a company. More specifically, it requires each team to choose a foreign country and a specific industry/market first and then to perform extensive analyses of the country and industry/market of your choice. In this project, you need to incorporate various global business environmental factors discussed in class, including country environmental factors (e.g., history, current politics, international issues, political, legal, economic, socio-cultural, and business practice-related environmental factors) and industry/market environmental factors (e.g., industry structure, market size, growth potential, driving forces, market segments, customer characteristics, channel environment, competitors, etc.).

Each team has to make two oral presentations of the field project: a preliminary one and a final one. No written report is required for this project. Preliminary oral presentation should be 15 minutes long with visual aids, followed by a 5- to 10-minute Q&A session. And final oral presentations should be approximately 30 minutes long, well-rehearsed, professional, and accompanied by visual aids. There will be a 10-15 minute Q&A session after each presentation. Specific criteria for evaluation will be provided in class. To be fair to each team, the time limit will be enforced. Presentations should be of the quality that you would feel comfortable making to the head of International Operations or your boss.

You are also required to submit a one-page progress report (see the course schedule below). The idea here is to push you to start your project early on so that you may finish your project on time without having trouble at the end. The report should include the country and industry/market that you have chosen, information that

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you have already collected, information that you still need to collect, and the timeline for completing the project.

Peer Evaluations

You will have an opportunity to evaluate your team members' contribution to team assignments. Evaluation forms will be provided, and they must be returned at the end of the term. Peer evaluations will be used in determining individual scores for team projects.

Grade Distribution Guideline:

A+ :	20%
A :	30%
B+ :	20%
B and below :	30%

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COURSE SCHEDULE

I. Introduction

Session 1 **Understanding Global Business Environment and Ethics**

9/2 R: “Globalization” 1

II. World Business Environment

Session 2 **Cross-Border Trade Environment**

9/9 R: “International Trade Theory” 2

Session 3 **Cross-Border Investment Environment**

9/16 R: “Foreign Direct Investment” 3

The one-page progress report on your field project is due on 9/16.

Session 4 **Regional Economic Integration**

9/23 R: “Regional Economic Integration” 4

Session 5 **Foreign Exchange Environment**

9/30 R: “Foreign Exchange Market” 5
 “Managing Foreign Exchange Risks” 6

III. Country/Industry/Market Business Environment

Session 6 **National Holiday (No Class)**

10/7

Session 7 **Country Business Environment**

10/14 R: “Country Analysis: A Framework to Identify and Evaluate” 7

C: KongZhong: Growth in a Dynamic Environment (Stanford case) 8

1. Based on the case and your own knowledge, what are the main differences between starting a technology company like KongZhong in China versus the U.S.? To what extent are the environmental and cultural differences important?
2. How have these differences affected the actions Yang and Yunfan took in starting KongZhong? How have they impacted the economic environment KongZhong is currently operating in?
3. Given the change in WVAS companies’ position in the industry in general and KongZhong’s position in particular, what options would you suggest Nick consider?

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Session 8 10/21	Mid-term Exam Period (No Class)	
Session 9 10/28	Industry/Market Business Environment	
R:	“Understanding Industry Structure”	9
	“Market Analysis”	10
C:	Apple and the Music Industry (HBS case)	11
	1. Apply Porter’s Five Forces model for industry analysis, explain the music industry evolved from physical sales to digital downloads, and examine the attractiveness of the industry from the perspective of recording companies both before and after Napster’s entry.	
	2. How does the analysis of political, economic, sociocultural, and technological (PEST) factors relate to the Five Forces analysis?	
	3. What is Apple’s strategy as it relates to the music industry, and what are the economics of that strategy?	
	4. What are the primary threats and opportunities facing Apple in the era of steaming music? How can the company best address them?	
Session 10 11/4	National Competitiveness	
R:	“The Competitive Advantage of Nations” (HBR)	12
C:	Finland and Nokia: Creating the World's Most Competitive Economy (HBS case)	13
	1. Why did Finland move from a sleepy economy to one of the most competitive nations in the world?	
	2. How was Finland able to become a world-leading nation in mobile communications? Why did this cluster emerge to drive growth rather than others?	
	3. Why did Nokia become a world leader in mobile handsets?	
	4. What are the critical challenges today for the Finnish government? For participants in the Finnish mobile communications cluster? For Nokia?	
	5. What should the government do in early 2002? What should the private sector do?	
Session 11 11/11	National Culture	
R:	“National Culture and Management” (HBS)	14
	“National cultural differences and global business”	15
C:	Establishing an “ECL” Culture in China: Organisational Difference or National Difference? (UHK case)	16
	1. Analyze the culture-learning process at ECL	
	2. Identify the cultural issues in ECL China and comment on ECL’s strategy of managing cultural differences	
	3. ECL China aims to speed up the development of local capabilities. What are the key success factors in the process of developing local capabilities?	
Session 12 11/18	Preliminary Oral Presentations for Your Field Project	

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IV. Sustainability and Business Ethics

Session 13 **CSR, SDGs, and ESG**

- 11/25 R: “Perfect Change” – Toward SDGs beyond CSR 17
 R: “Paradigm Shift” – ESG management for improving sustainability 18
 C: Passion and Strategy: Novozymes’ Embrace of the UN SDGs (HBS case) 19
1. How has Novozymes embraced the UN SDGs for its strategy development?
 2. What do you think of Novozymes’ embracing the UN SDGs for its strategy development? Is it beneficial or harmful for a company to rely on the UN SDGs for its strategy development for its growth and profitability?
 3. What should Novozymes do with respect to the UN SDGs?

Session 14 **Business Ethics 1**

- 12/2 R: “Ethics: A Basic Framework” (HBS) 20
 C: Ethics of Off-shoring: Novo Nordisk and Clinical Trials in Emerging Economies 21
1. Considering both economic and ethical aspects, is it appropriate for companies like Novo Nordisk to conduct clinical trials in, for example, India? What exactly are the principles that should guide such a decision?
 2. If trials are conducted in an emerging economy, how should they be managed and which standards should apply?
 3. What interest groups are joining the public debate and why? How should business handle them? What is the role, respectively, of Danish, European, American and host country authorizes and ethics committees in this process?
 4. How should Anders Dejgaard react when the journalist calls to discuss Novo Nordisk’s practices? What is the most effective way to communicate with the public?

Session 15 **Business Ethics 2**

- 12/9 R: “Ethical Breakdowns” (HBR) 22
 R: “Where is your company most prone to lapses into in integrity?” 23

Session 16 **Final Field Project Presentations**

12/16 *Final oral presentations of your field project*

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ASSIGNMENT SCHEDULE (Actual dates of the presentations of the assigned projects)

1. Individual Topic Presentations

Session 3: 김동찬, 이석주
9/16

Session 4: 김윤진, 김지후
9/23

Session 5: 강석범, 장지후
9/30

2. Individual Case Project Presentations

Session 9 KongZhong: Growth in a Dynamic Environment (Stanford University case)
10/28 _____

Session 10 Apple and the Music Industry (HBS case)
11/4 _____

Session 11 Finland and Nokia: Creating the World's Most Competitive Economy (HBS case)
11/11 _____

Session 12 Establishing an “ECL” Culture in China (UHK case)
11/18 _____

Session 14 Passion and Strategy: Novozymes’ Embrace of the UN SDGs (HBS case)
12/2 _____

Session 15 Ethics of Off-shoring: Novo Nordisk and Clinical Trials in Emerging Economies (HBS)
12/9 _____

3. Team Field Project

Session 3 *One-page progress report on your field project*
9/16 팀1: 팀2: 팀3:

Session 12 *Preliminary oral presentations for your field project*
11/18

Session 16 *Final oral presentations for your field project*
12/16

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